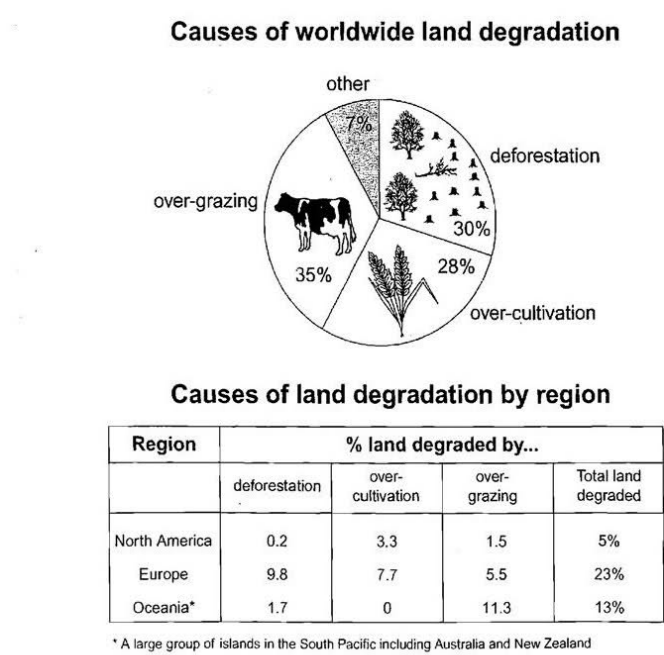


Pie chart + table (sample answer)



Sample Answer for band 7

The pie chart and table compare the causes of land degradation in the world and in three different regions: North America, Oceania, and Europe, from 1990 to 1999.

Overall, it can be clearly observed that while over-grazing was the main reason for global land degradation, Europe had the highest proportion of degraded land.

Starting with the factors of land degradation in the world, at 30%, over-grazing accounted for the highest ratio among all causes, followed by deforestation, and over-cultivation at 30% and 28%, respectively. However, 7% of the degraded land resulted from unidentified reasons.

With regard to causes classified by regions, 23% of Europe’s total agricultural land was less productive, which was contributed primarily by deforestation at 9.8% and excessive cultivation at 7.7%. On the other hand, North America had the smallest percentage of degraded land at 5%, mainly caused by over-cultivation at 3.3% and over-grazing at 1.5%. Finally, it is interesting to note that although 13% of Oceania’s total land was degraded, the region was not affected by too much cultivation at all.